How to use IMS

IMS tracks two kinds of things:

- **Stock**: things you count and give out, like gloves, pants or cable ties. IMS keeps the number on hand.
- **Assets**: equipment you lend out and get back, like drills or laptops. Each one has its own tag (TOOL-0001) and history.

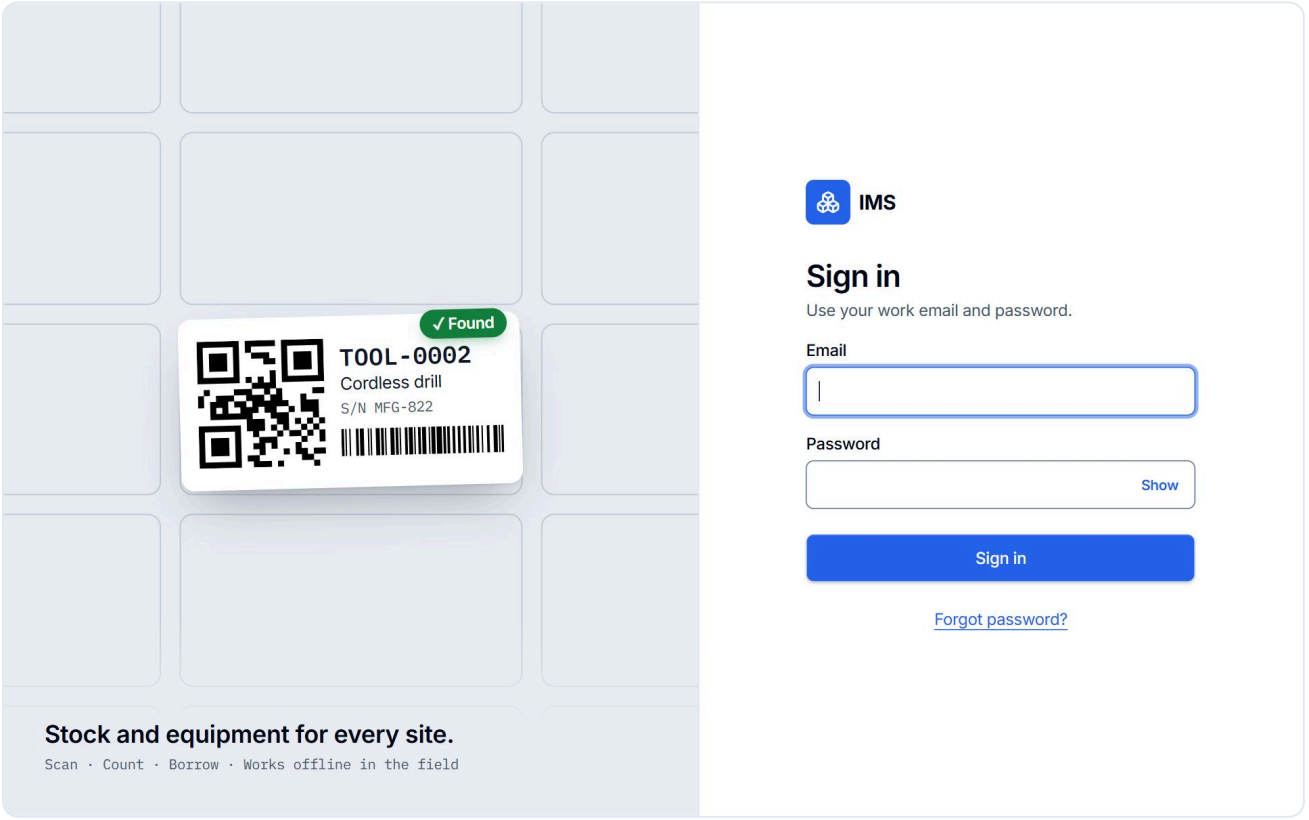
Works on a phone, tablet or computer. Words in **bold** are exactly what you see on screen. Pictures use sample data.

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1. Sign in

1. Open the IMS link.
2. Type your **Email** and **Password**.
3. Press **Sign in**.

Forgot your password? Ask your administrator for a reset link.



2. Who can do what

You are	You can
Admin	Everything, plus users and the audit log
Supervisor	At your locations: add items and assets, receive / issue / transfer stock, lend and take back equipment, run and approve counts
Field staff	Count with your phone (works without internet) and send borrow requests

3. Stock or Asset? Decide before you add an item

Ask: **"Do I need to know *which one*?"**

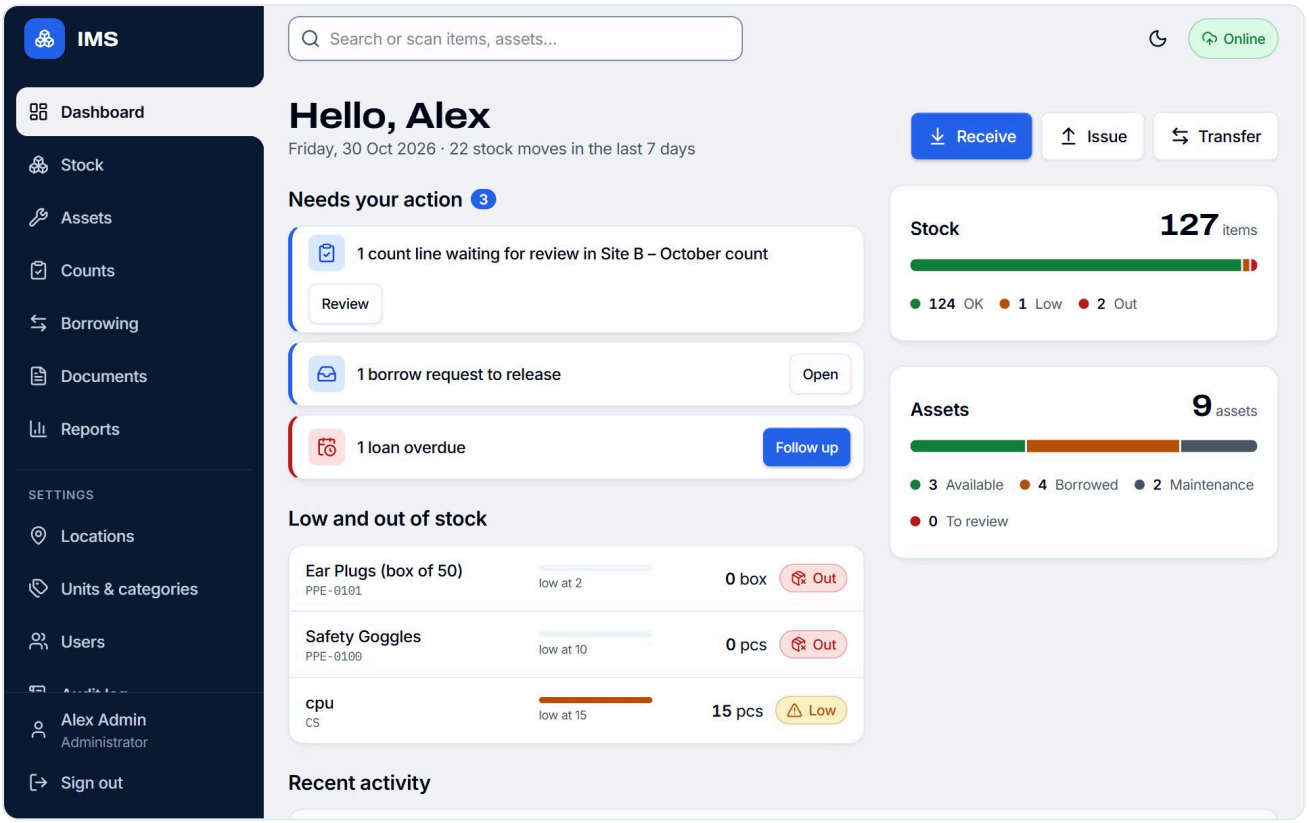
Stock	Asset
No. Any pair of pants is the same	Yes. *This* laptop went to Juan, due back Friday
Kept as a number: "3 pair at MAIN-WH"	Each unit has its own tag: LAP-0001, LAP-0002…
Comes in with **Receive**	Comes in with **Add assets**
Goes out with **Issue** (not returned)	Goes out with **Borrow** and comes back with **Return**

You can't change this later. If you pick the wrong one, make a new item with a new SKU.

4. Office: the dashboard

The **Dashboard** opens when you sign in.

- **Needs your action** at the top is your to-do list. Clear it and your day is done.
- **Receive**, **Issue** and **Transfer** buttons are at the top right.



Receive, Issue, Transfer and Borrow all have the same 4 steps: **Where** → **What** → **Who** → **Review**. The **Next** button names the next step (e.g. **Next: What**). Nothing changes until you press the confirm button on the last step.

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5. Office: stock

Add a new item

1. Open **Stock**.
2. Press **Add item** (below the search box).
3. **How is it tracked?**: choose **Stock** or **Asset** (see section 3).
4. Fill in **SKU** (a unique code, like `PPE-0001`), **Name** and **Unit**.
5. Optional: **Category**, **Low-stock level** (stock only), **Manufacturer barcode**, **Description**.
6. Optional: **Photo**: choose a picture (on a phone you can take one), so everyone knows exactly which item it is.
7. Press **Add item**.

Add or change a photo later: open the item → **Add photo** / **Change photo**, or **Remove**. The photo also shows as a small picture in the **Stock** list.

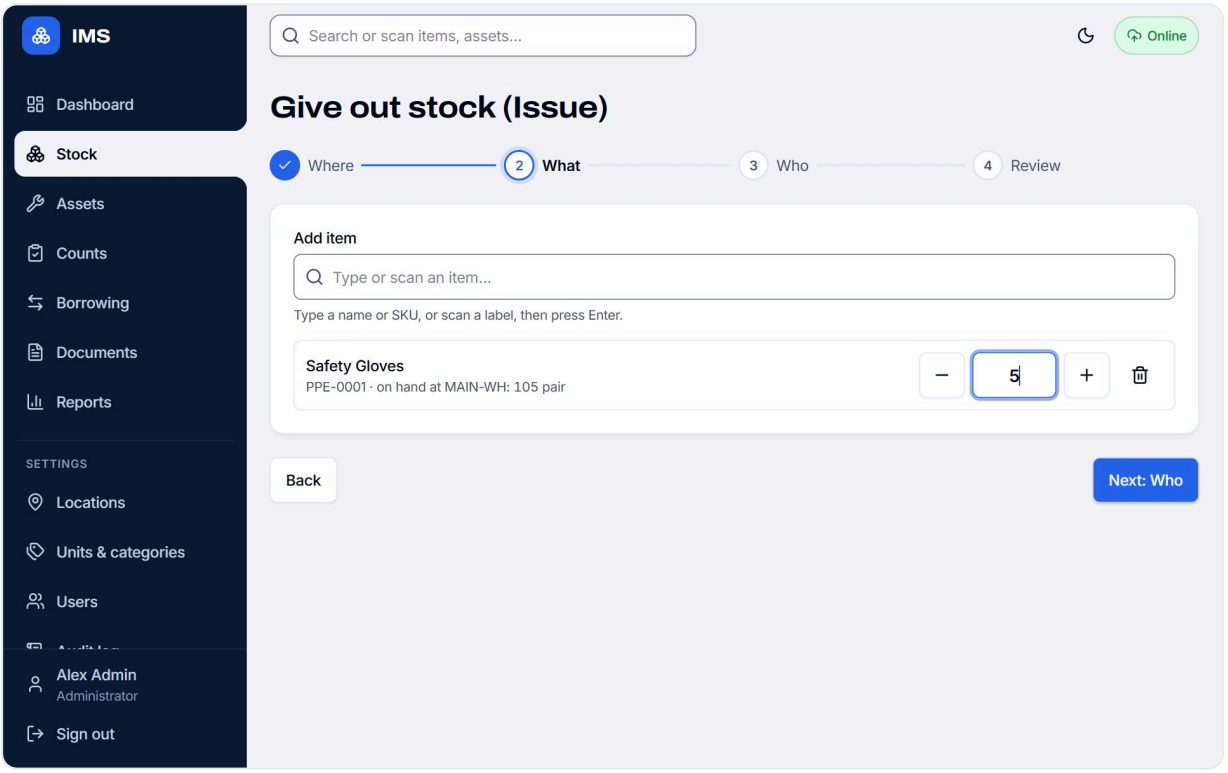
Many items at once: **Stock** → **Import CSV** → choose the file → fix any red rows → **Import … valid rows**.

Receive stock (a delivery came in)

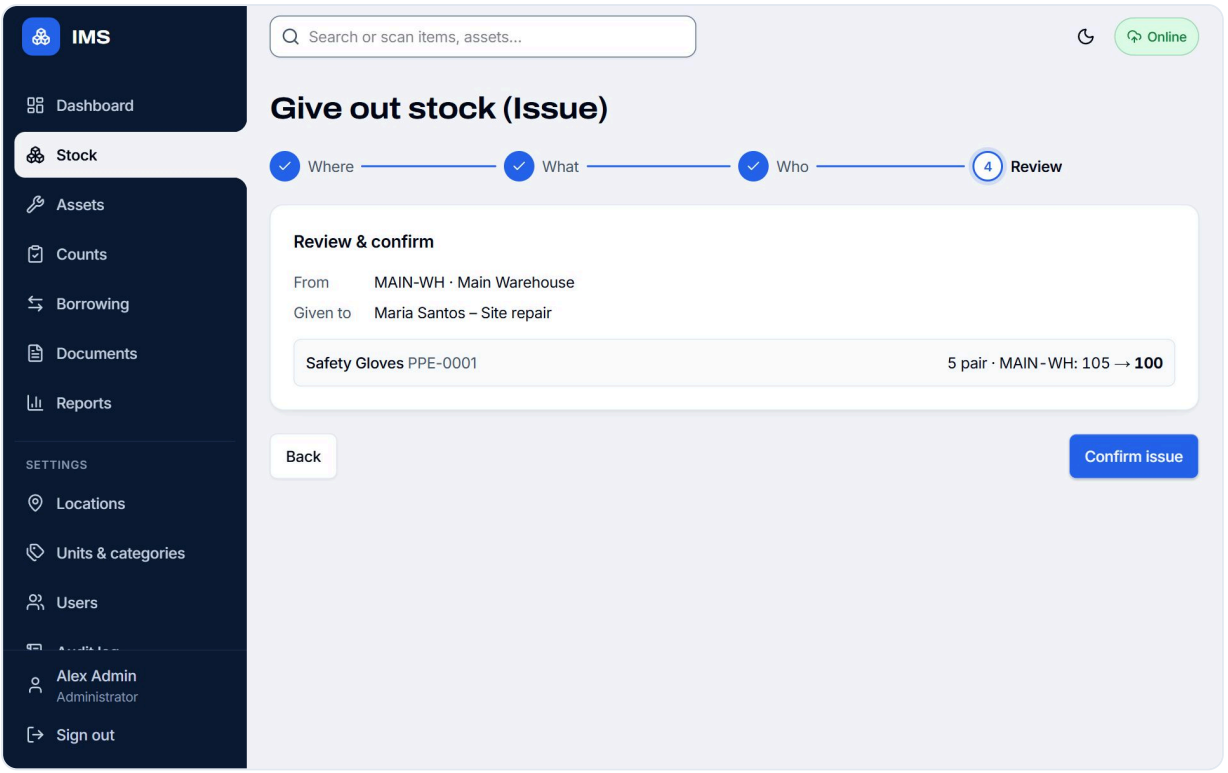
1. **Dashboard** → **Receive**.
2. **Receive at**: pick the location → **Next**.
3. **Add item**: scan or type the name or SKU, press Enter, then type how many. Repeat for each item → **Next**.
4. Optional: **Received from** (supplier) and **Delivery note / PO number** → **Next**.
5. Check the numbers → **Confirm receipt**.

Give out stock (Issue)

1. **Dashboard** → **Issue**.
2. **Issue from**: pick the location → **Next**.
3. Add the items and how many → **Next**.



4. **Given to** and **Purpose** (work order or reason) → **Next**.
5. Check the before → after numbers → **Confirm issue**.



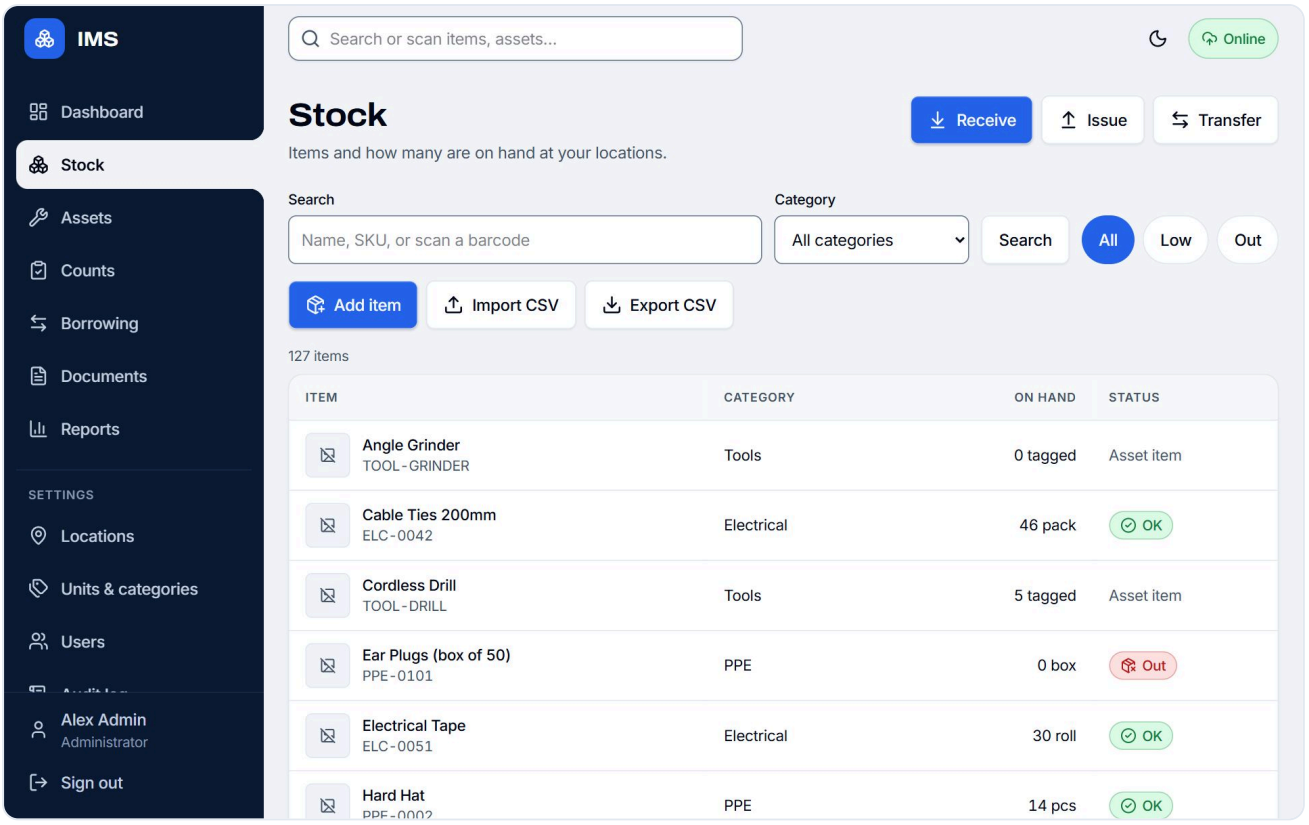
6. Press **Print** or **Download PDF** to get the **Stock Issuance form** for signing.

Move stock to another location (Transfer)

1. **Dashboard** → **Transfer**.
2. **From** and **To** → **Next**.
3. Add the items and how many → **Next**.
4. Optional: **Reason** → **Next**.
5. **Confirm transfer**, then print the **Transmittal form**.

Find anything

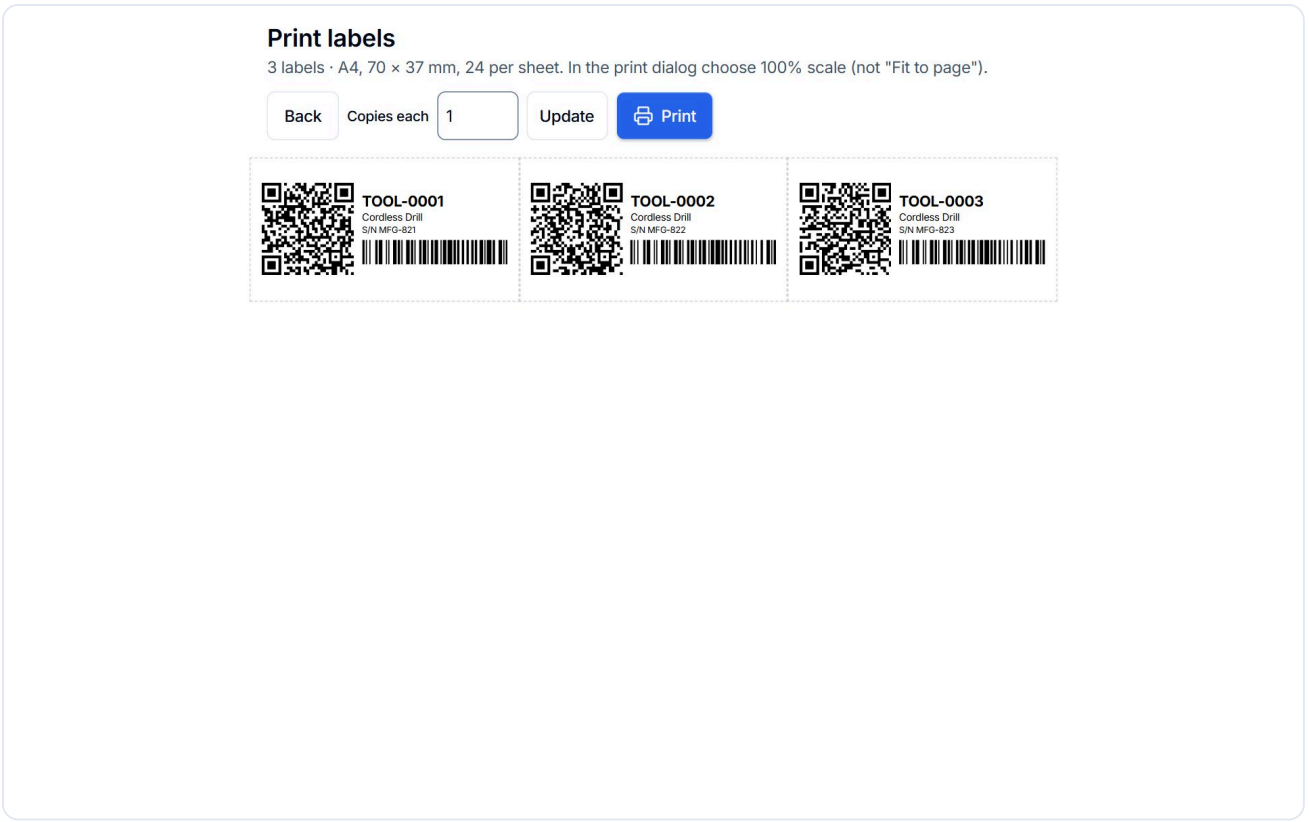
Type or scan in the search box at the top: a name, SKU, asset tag, serial or barcode. On a phone: **Scan** → **Type code instead**, and start typing (even part of a SKU or name). Matching items, assets and locations appear under the box; tap one to open it. Or open **Stock** and tap **Low** or **Out** to see what needs reordering.



6. Office: assets (equipment)

Add equipment

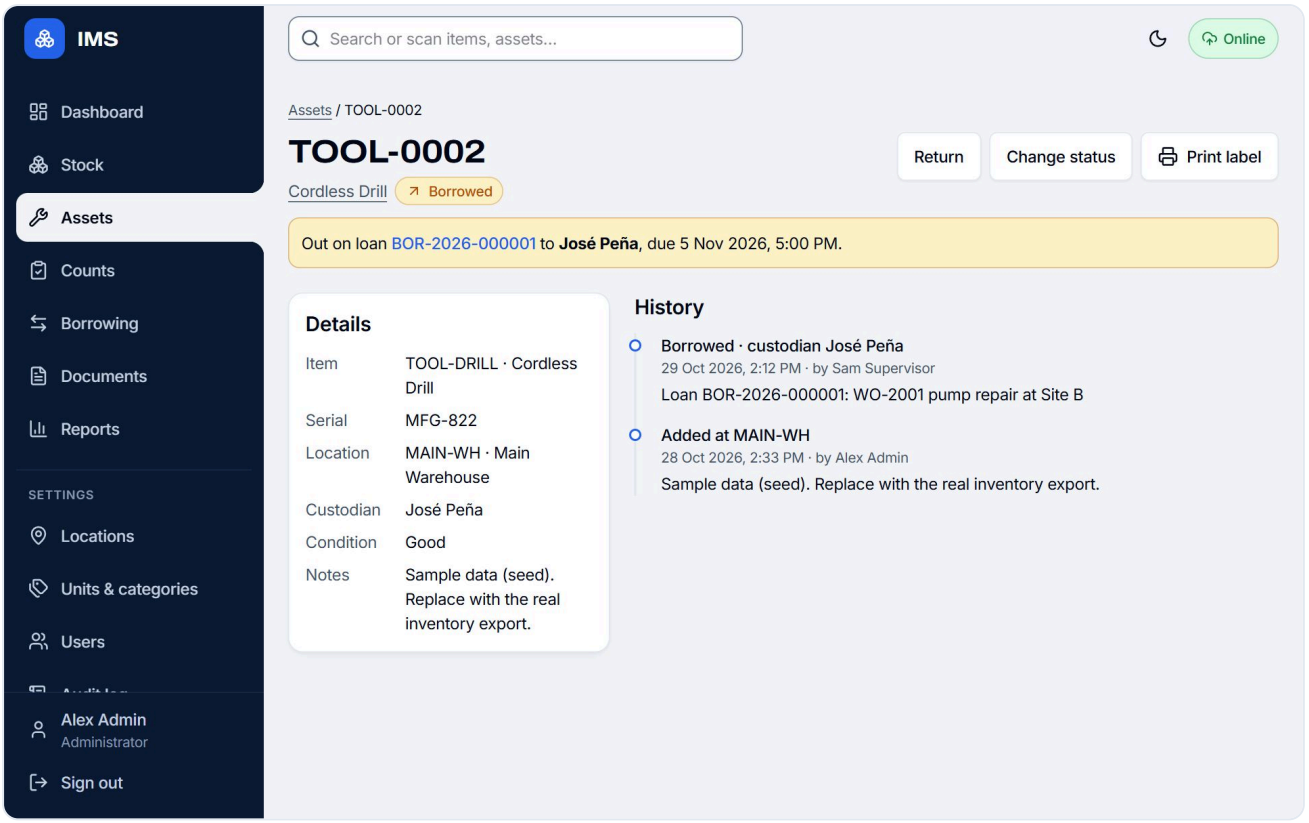
1. First make the item with **How is it tracked?** = **Asset** (section 5, "Add a new item").
2. Open **Assets** → **Add assets**.
3. **Asset item**: type the item's SKU and pick it.
4. **Location**: where it's kept.
5. **How many?**: one tag is made for each.
6. **Tag prefix**: a short code like `LAP`. Tags become LAP-0001, LAP-0002…
7. **Condition**: Good, Fair or Damaged.
8. Optional: **Serial numbers** (one per line, same order as the tags), **Custodian**, **Notes**.
9. Press **Add … assets**.
10. Press **Print … labels**. Print on A4 label paper (3 × 8, 70 × 37 mm) at **100% scale**, then stick one label on each unit.



See or change one asset

Open **Assets** → tap the asset. You see its details and full history.

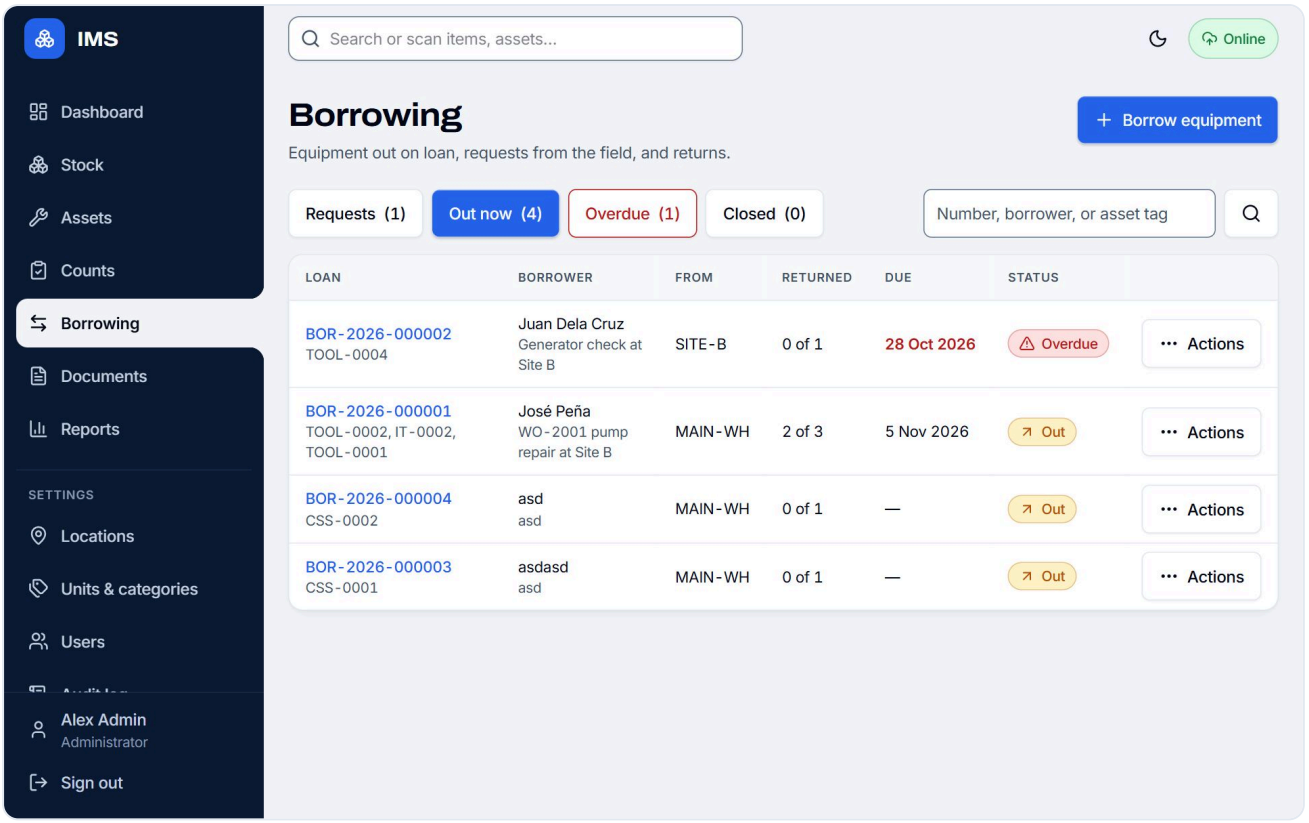
- **Borrow**: lend it (only when **Available**).
- **Return**: take it back (only when **Borrowed**).
- **Change status**: for example **Under maintenance**, **Lost** or **Retired**. You must give a reason.
- **Print label**: reprint a lost or damaged label.



Lend equipment (Borrow)

1. **Borrowing** → **Borrow equipment**.
2. **Release from**: where the equipment is now → **Next**.
3. **Add asset**: scan or type each tag and press Enter. Set **Condition** and **Accessories** (e.g. charger) → **Next**.
4. **Borrower** and **Purpose**. Optional: **Department or site**, **Due back**, **Physically received by**, **Notes** → **Next**.
5. Check everything. Optional: **Prepared by** (who got the equipment ready; leave it empty to use your name). **Preview form (DRAFT)** shows the form before anything is saved.
6. **Confirm release**.
7. Print the **Equipment Borrowing form** and have the borrower sign it.

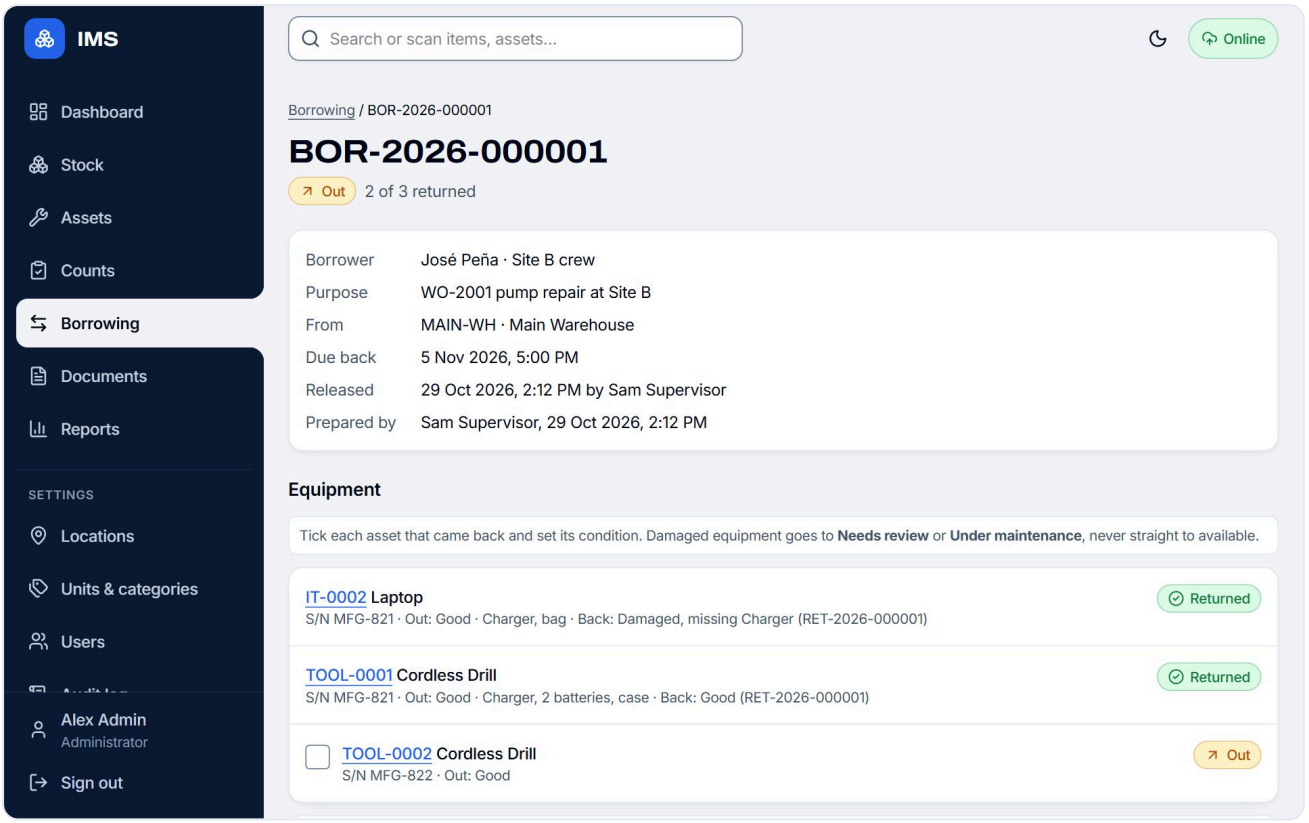
Tabs on **Borrowing**: **Requests** (from the field), **Out now**, **Overdue** (red), **Closed**.



Take equipment back (Return)

1. **Borrowing** → open the loan → **Return equipment**.
2. Tick each asset that came back.
3. **Condition now** for each. If it's **Damaged**, pick **Send to**: **Needs review** or **Under maintenance**.
4. Optional: **Missing accessories**, **Notes**.
5. **Brought back by** and **Received at**.
6. **Confirm return**, then print the **Return Acknowledgment** form.

You can return some items now and the rest later.



Release a borrow request from the field

1. **Borrowing** → **Requests** tab.
2. Open the request → **Check and release**.
3. Check the assets and details, then **Confirm release** as in "Lend equipment".

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7. Office: stock counts

Start a count

1. **Counts** → **New count**.
2. **Location to count** and a **Name** → **Next**.
3. **Count**: **Stock quantities** and/or **Tagged assets**. **Which items**: everything, or only some categories → **Next**.
4. **Who counts**: tick the people → **Next**.
5. Optional: **Finish counting by** and **Instructions for counters** → **Next**.
6. **Create count**.

Don't move stock at that location while it's being counted.

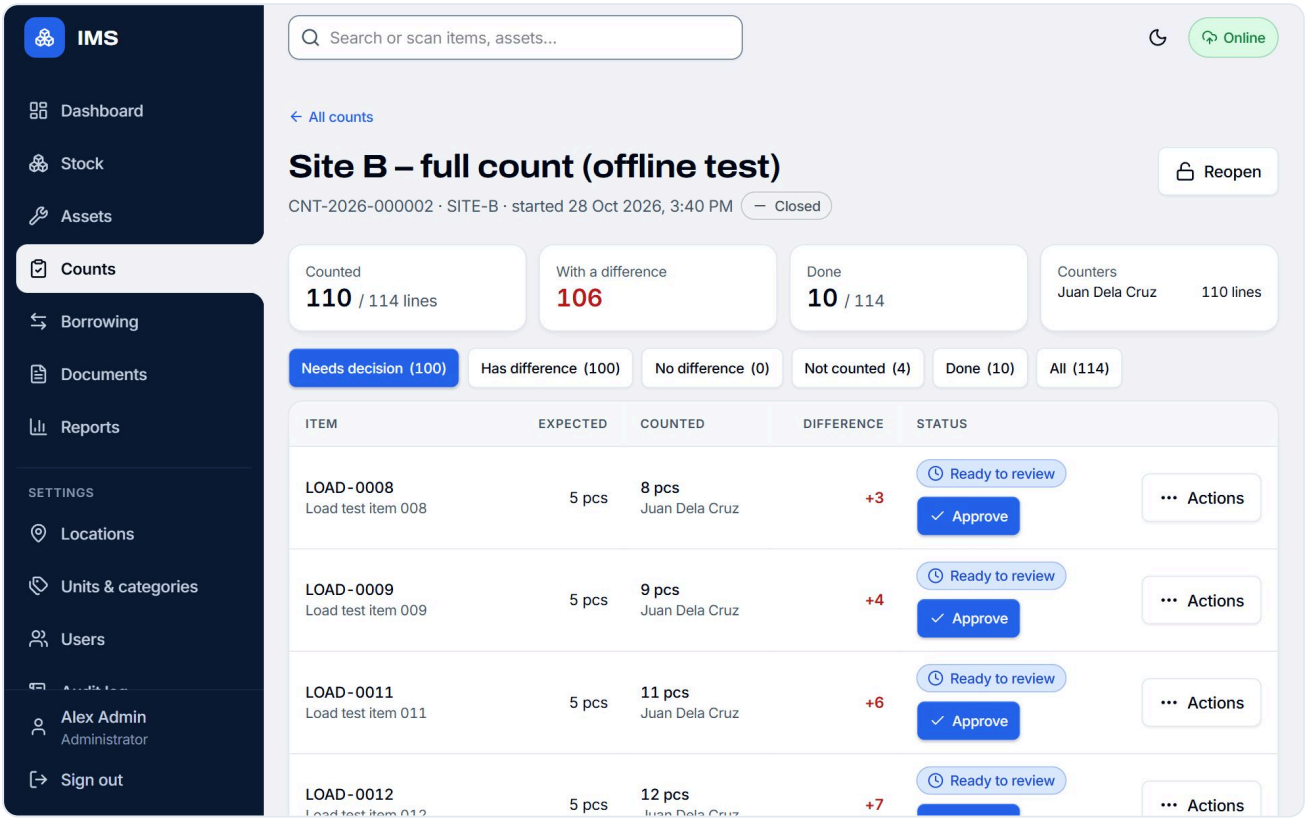
Review a count

1. **Counts** → open the count.
2. For each line:

- **Approve**: set the stock to the counted number.
- **Request recount** (in the line's menu): ask for it to be counted again.
- **Keep expected** (in the line's menu): ignore the counted number.

3. **Approve … with no difference** approves every line that already matches in one go.
4. When every line is done → **Close count**.

Counting alone never changes stock. Only **Approve** does.

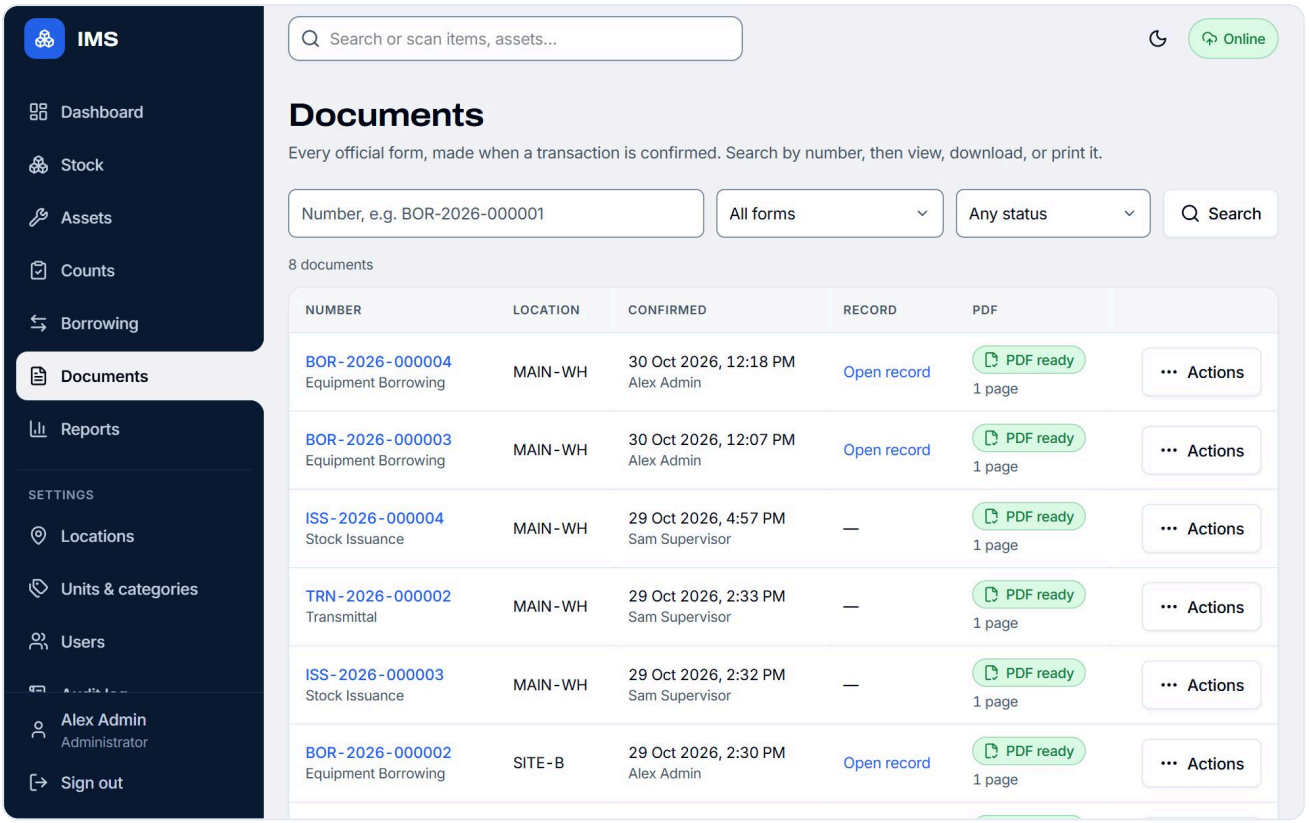


8. Office: forms and reports

Forms (PDFs)

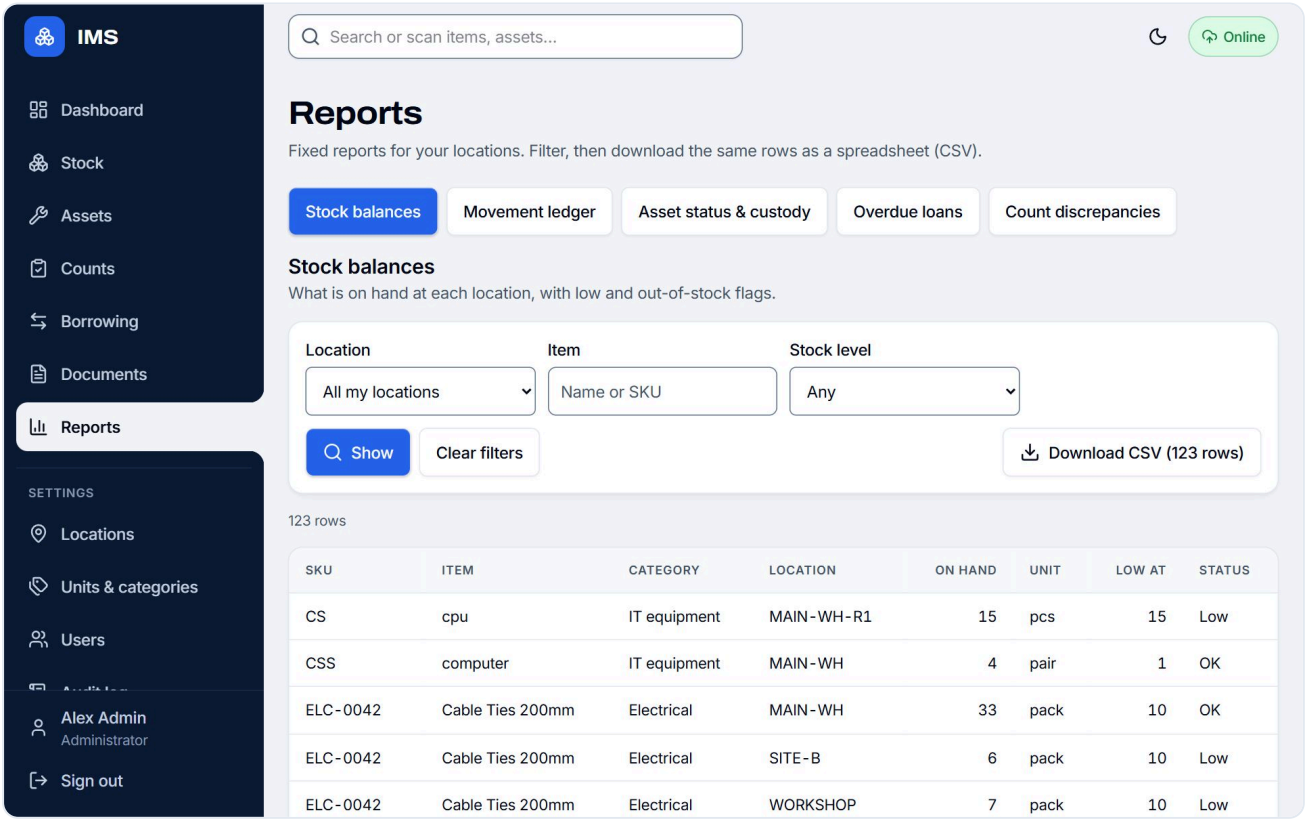
1. Open **Documents**.
2. Search by number (e.g. `ISS-2026-000123`).
3. **View**, **Download PDF** or **Print**.

If it says "PDF failed", press **Retry PDF**. The stock is already saved; this only remakes the form.



Reports

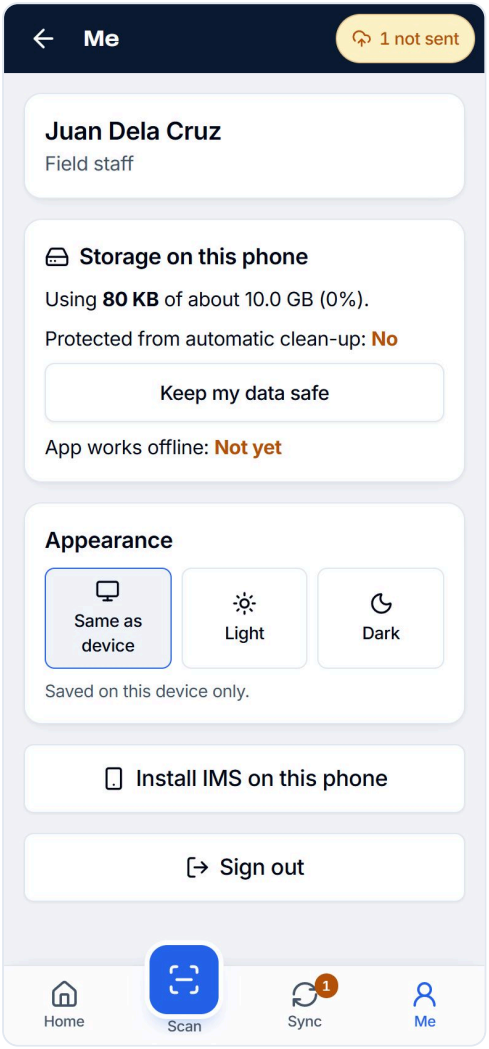
1. Open **Reports** and pick a report.
2. Set the filters.
3. **Download CSV** (opens in Excel).



9. Field: counting with your phone

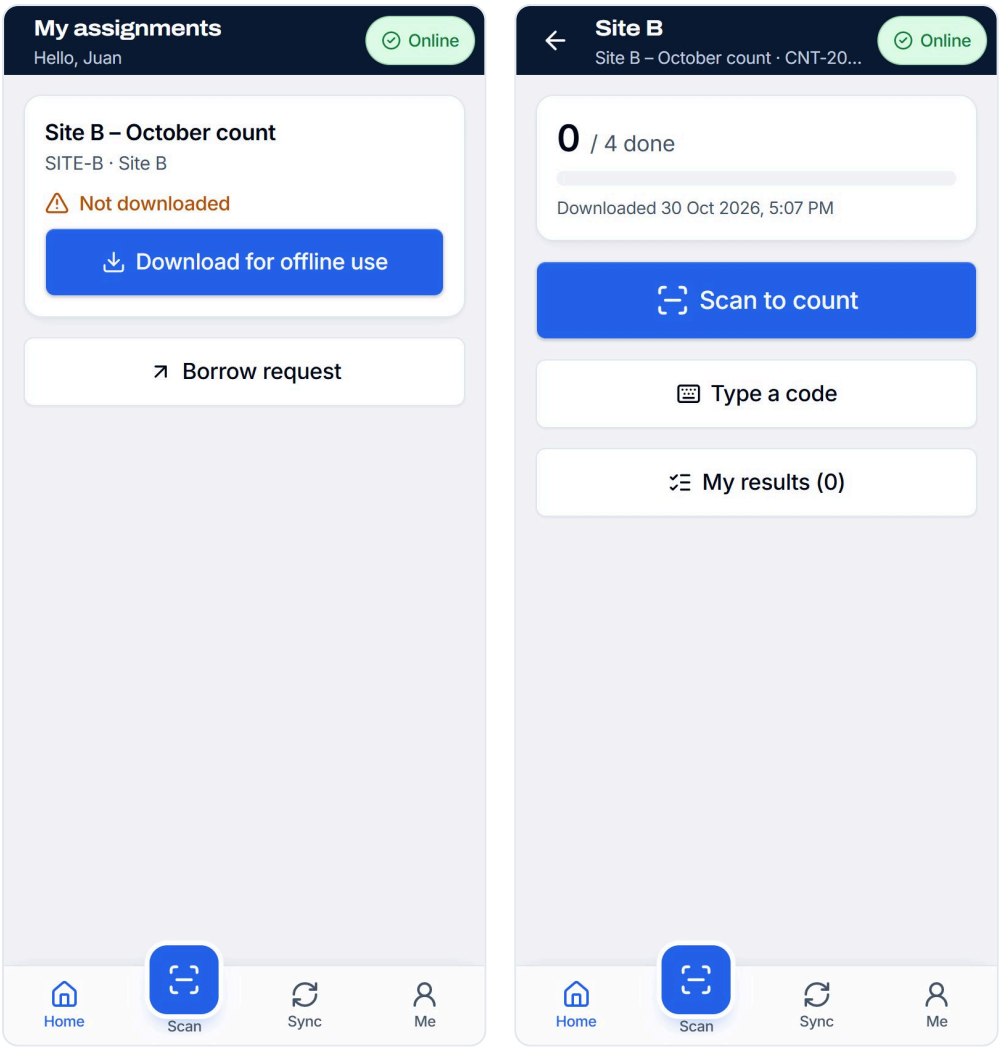
First time (needs internet)

1. Open the IMS link on your phone and sign in.
2. **Me** → **Install IMS on this phone** → follow the steps for Android or iPhone.
3. From now on, open IMS from the new icon on your home screen.



Before you go out (needs internet)

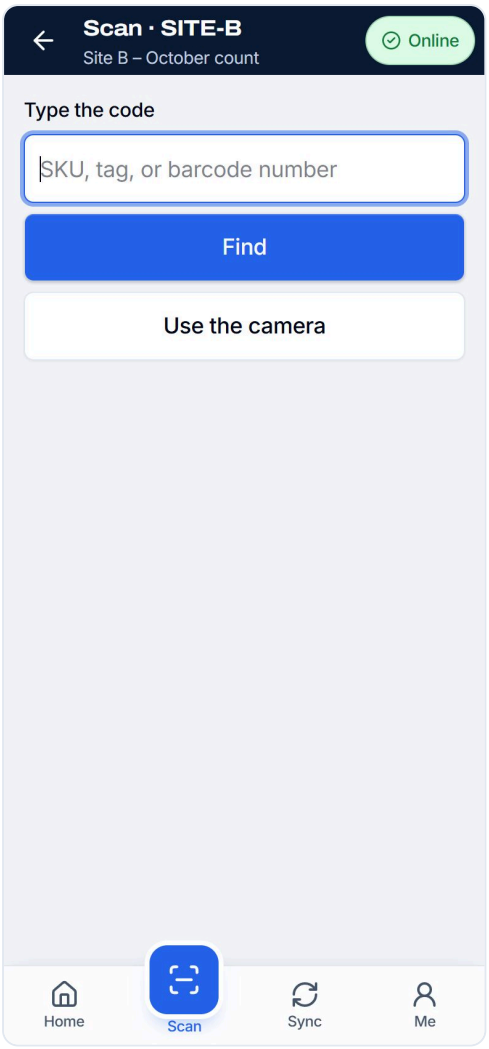
1. **Home** → find your assignment.
2. Press **Download for offline use**.
3. Wait for **Ready for offline use**. Now it works without signal.

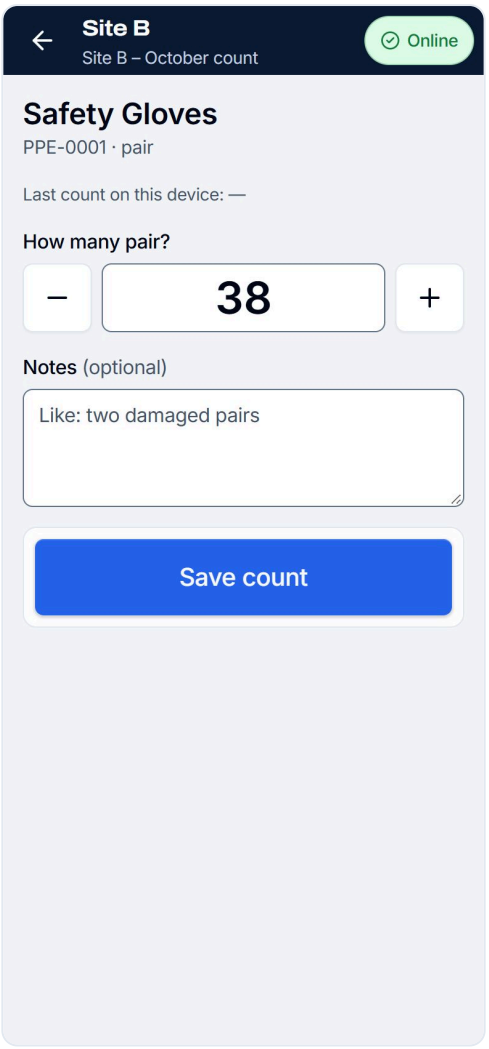


Count

1. Open the assignment → **Scan to count**.
2. Point the camera at the label. Camera not working? Press **Type a code**.
3. For a **stock item**: type how many → **Save count**.
4. For **equipment**: tap **Found** or **Not found**. If found, pick the condition → **Save check**.
5. Scan the next one.

Scanned the same thing twice? It opens your saved count. It does **not** add it again. To fix a count: **My results** → tap the line → change it.

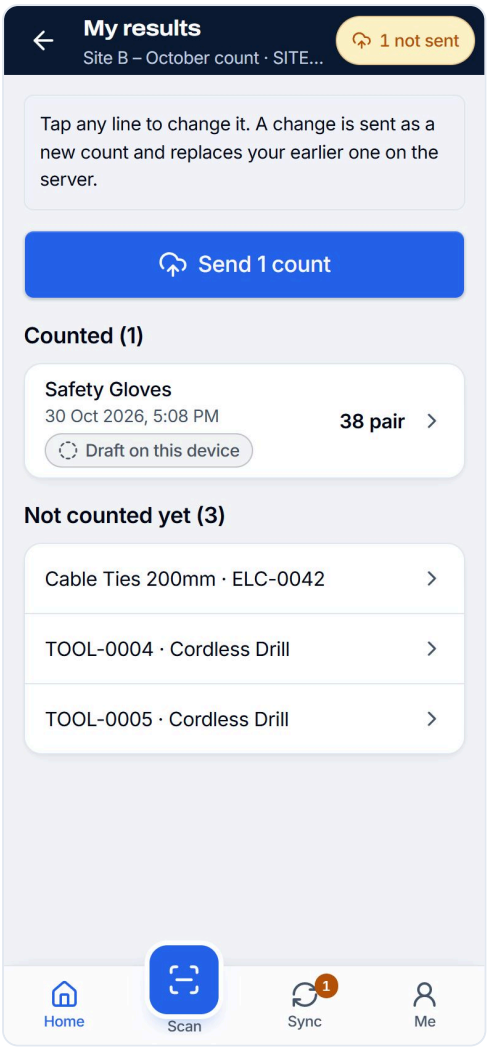


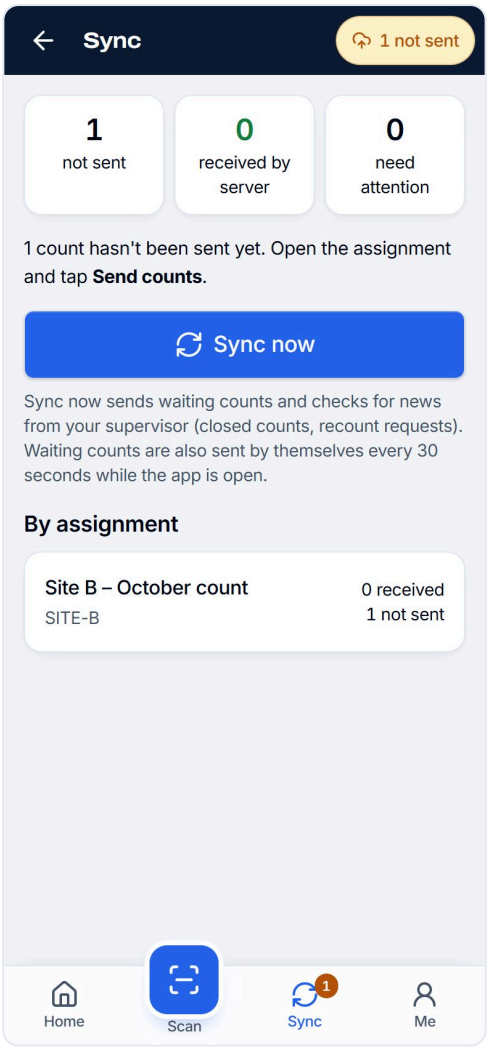


Send your counts (needs internet)

1. Open the assignment or **My results**.
2. Press **Send … counts** (e.g. **Send 3 counts**).

The pill at the top shows where they are: **3 not sent** = still on your phone. **All sent** = the office has them. No signal? Your counts stay safe on the phone. Send them later from **Sync** → **Sync now**.

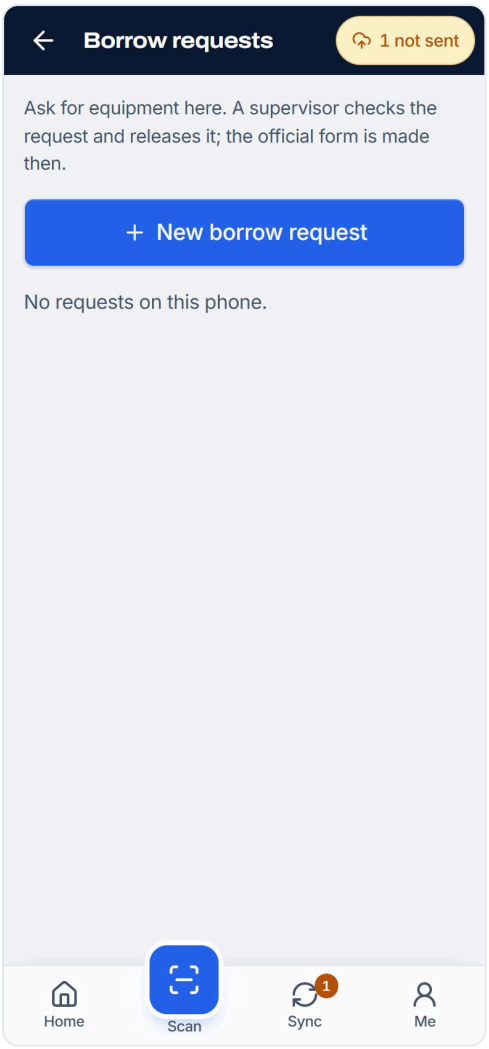




Ask to borrow equipment

1. **Home → Borrow request → New borrow request**.
2. **Equipment is at**: pick the location.
3. **Assets**: type a tag or name. Matching equipment appears; tap **Add** on one marked **Available**. Red text means it can't be borrowed (already out, under maintenance…) or doesn't exist at that location. You can also **Scan a label**.
4. **Borrower** and **Purpose**. Optional: **Department or site**, **Notes**.
5. **Save on this phone**.
6. **Send to supervisor** (needs internet).

It's only a request. A supervisor does the official release.

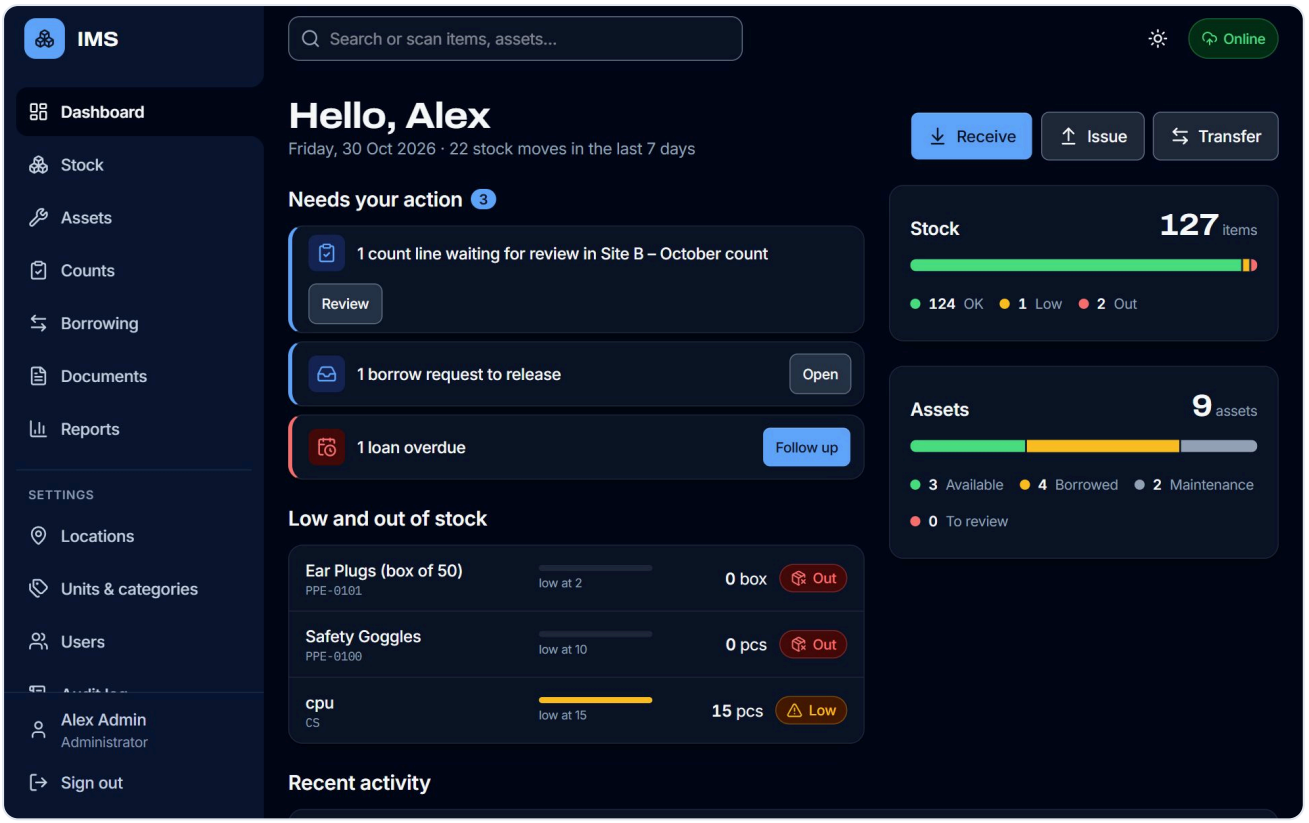


10. What the colors mean

Color	Means
Green	OK · Available · Done · All sent
Orange	Low stock · Borrowed · Not sent yet
Red	Out of stock · Overdue · Problem, needs action
Grey	Inactive · Retired · Draft

11. Dark mode

Tap the sun / moon button at the top. Or **Me** → **Appearance** → **Same as device**, **Light** or **Dark**.



12. Problems

Problem	Do this
"... is counted stock, not an asset item"	That item is Stock. Make a new item with **How is it tracked?** = **Asset**
No **Add assets** button on an item	The item is Stock. Use **Receive** for it, or make a new Asset item
Camera won't open	Allow the camera for IMS in the phone settings, or use **Type a code**
"Not downloaded"	Get internet, then **Download for offline use**
Counts stuck on "not sent"	Get internet → **Sync** → **Sync now**
"Only 3 left" when issuing	Lower the quantity or pick another location
Asset can't be borrowed	It's borrowed, under maintenance, lost or retired. Check its status on **Assets**
Forgot password	Ask the admin: **Users** → **Reset link**

13. Don't

- **Don't clear browser data or uninstall** while counts are not sent. Unsent counts would be lost.
- **Don't share your account.** Every action is recorded under your name.
- **Don't go out of signal without downloading** your assignment first.

14. Settings

Admin only:

- **Users** → **Add user** → set a **Temporary password** and give it to the person directly. Menu on a user: **Reset link**, **Deactivate**.
- **Audit log**: who did what, and when.

Admin and supervisors:

- **Locations** → **Add location** (warehouse, site, rack).
- **Units & categories**: the lists used when adding items.